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Creating a Portal and Portal Users in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create a tenant portal for the RentEase application, to give portal users limited access with the Tenant_Profile permission set, to invite a tenant as a portal user, and to verify that the tenant can sign in and raise a maintenance request.

2. Introduction

2.1 Portals in Zoho Creator

A portal gives people outside the organisation, such as customers, tenants or vendors, access to a part of an application. A portal user signs in with his own account and sees only the forms and reports that his permission set allows. This keeps the internal data private while letting outside users do their own work. The steps in building a portal are to create the portal, define the permission set for its users, invite the users and test the sign-in.

2.2 The Tenant Portal of RentEase

In RentEase, tenants do not need the whole application. A tenant needs to see his lease, his invoices and his payments, and to raise a repair request or a move-out request. RentEase has one portal, and it is for tenants only. The manager and the owner are internal users and do not use the portal. The tenant Rahul Verma was invited to the portal and used it to raise a maintenance request.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To create a portal for the tenants of RentEase.
- To define the Tenant_Profile permission set and make it the default for portal users.
- To invite a tenant as a portal user.
- To sign in as the tenant and raise a maintenance request.
- To check that the request reaches the manager's side of the application.

4. Procedure

1. Open the RentEase application in Edit mode and open the Portal section.
2. Create a portal named RentEase and set its type to Public.
3. Open Settings > Portal User Permissions and create the permission set Tenant_Profile. Give Access and View to the Lease_Agreement, Rent_Invoice, Rent_Payment, Maintenance_Request and Move_Out_Request reports and no other rights.
4. Set Tenant_Profile as the default permission set of the portal.
5. Open the portal users list and invite the tenant Rahul Verma with his email address.
6. Open the invitation email as the tenant, accept it and set a password.
7. Sign in at the portal URL as Rahul Verma and check the forms and reports that appear.
8. Open the Maintenance_Request form in the portal, fill it and submit it.
9. Sign in as the admin and check that the new request appears in the Maintenance_Request report.

10. Take a screenshot of each step.

5. Detailed Analysis of the Portal

Table 1 lists the settings of the RentEase portal.

Item	Setting
Portal name	RentEase
Portal type	Public
Users of the portal	Tenants only
Permission set	Tenant_Profile
Default permission set	Tenant_Profile
Invited portal user	Rahul Verma

Table 1: Settings of the RentEase portal

Table 2 follows the portal from set-up to the first request of the tenant.

Step	Done by	Action	Result
1	Admin	Creates the RentEase portal	A portal for tenants exists
2	Admin	Defines the Tenant_Profile permission set	Tenants are limited to five forms and their reports
3	Admin	Invites Rahul Verma	An invitation email is sent to the tenant
4	Tenant	Accepts the invitation and signs in at the portal URL	The tenant sees the portal
5	Tenant	Opens the Maintenance_Request form and submits it	A repair request is created
6	Admin	Opens the Maintenance_Request report	The request is visible to the manager's side

Table 2: From portal set-up to the tenant's first request

Table 3 shows what the Tenant_Profile permission set gives to a portal user.

Component	Access	View (report)	Edit	Delete
Lease_Agreement	Yes	Lease_Agreement Report	No	No
Rent_Invoice	Yes	Rent_Invoice Report	No	No
Rent_Payment	Yes	Rent_Payment Report	No	No
Maintenance_Request	Yes	Maintenance_Request Report	No	No
Move_Out_Request	Yes	Move_Out_Request Report	No	No
Property, Unit, Tenant, Vendor, Repair_Approval, Command Center	No	-	No	No

Table 3: Access given by the Tenant_Profile permission set

During testing, the tenant reports in the portal showed No Data Available. This was not a fault of the portal or the permission set. The sample leases, invoices and payments had been created by the admin, and a tenant sees only the records that belong to him. Records created by or shared with the tenant appear in the portal.

6. Output

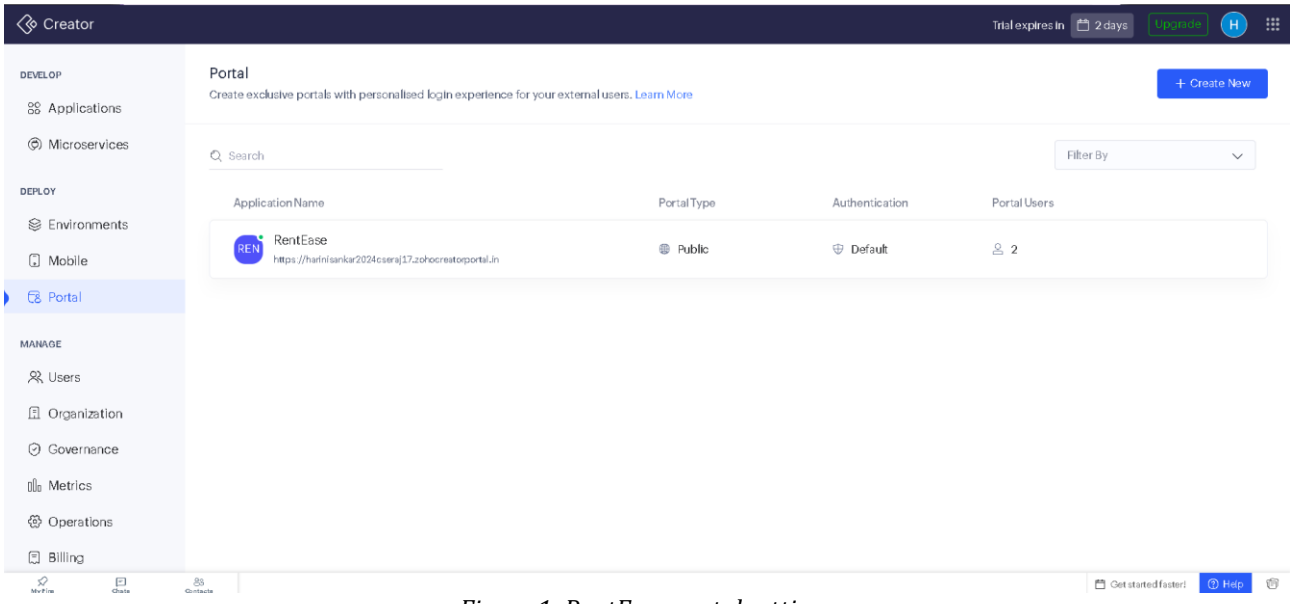


Figure 1: RentEase portal settings

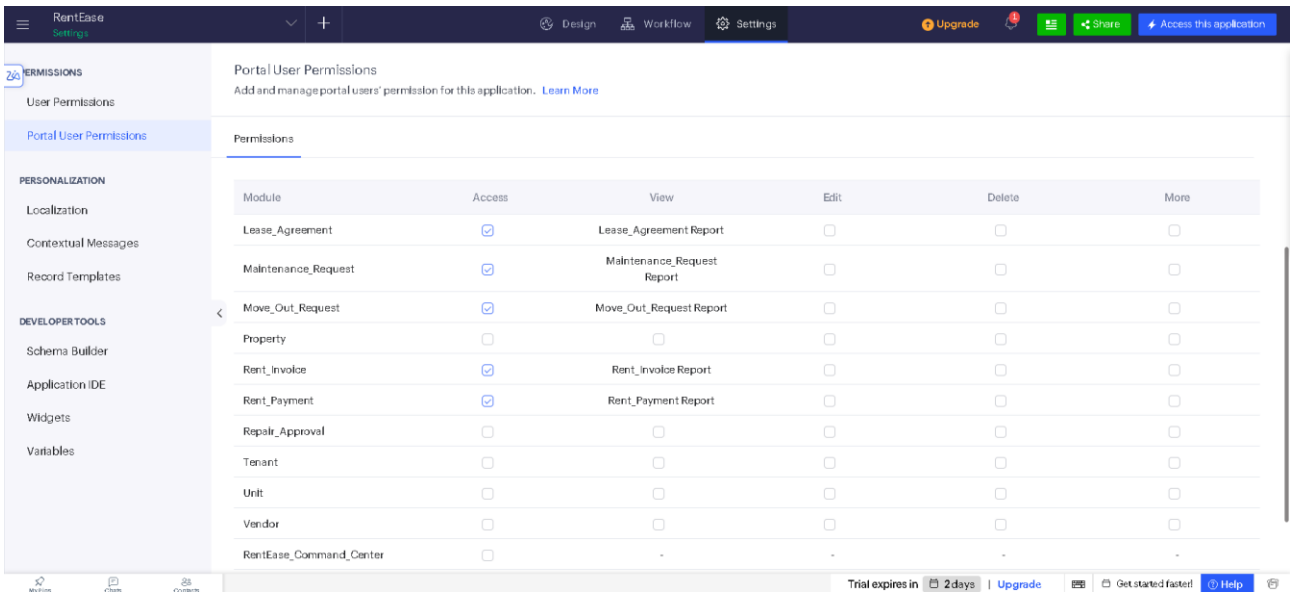


Figure 2: Tenant_Profile permission set

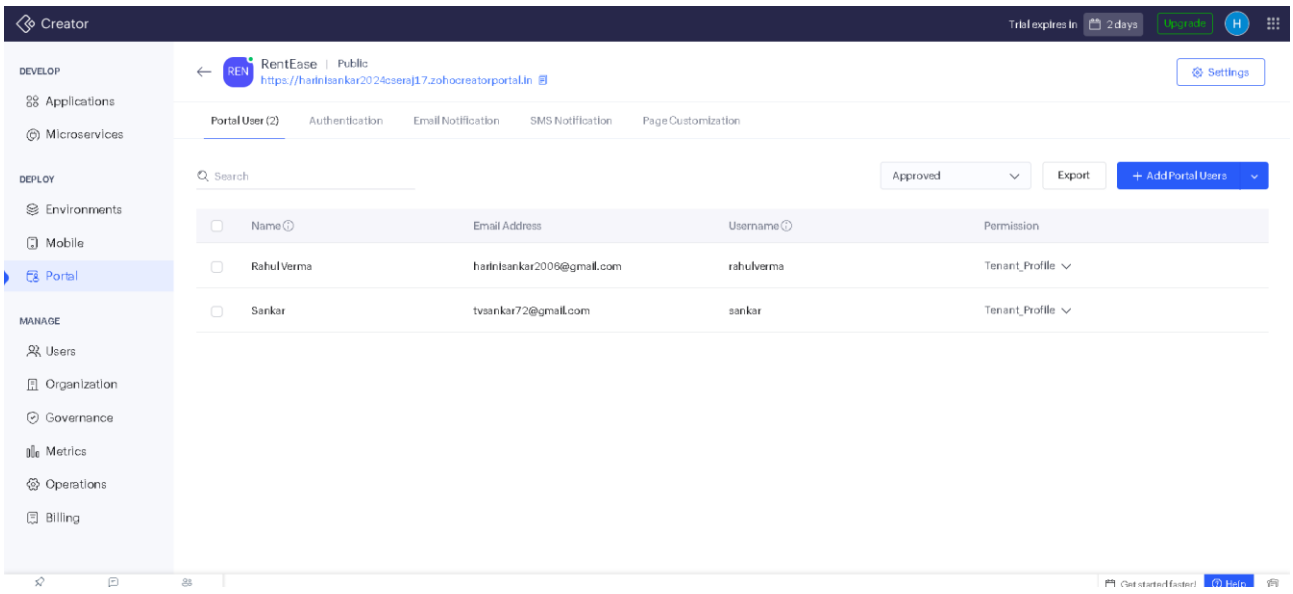


Figure 3: Tenant invited as a portal user

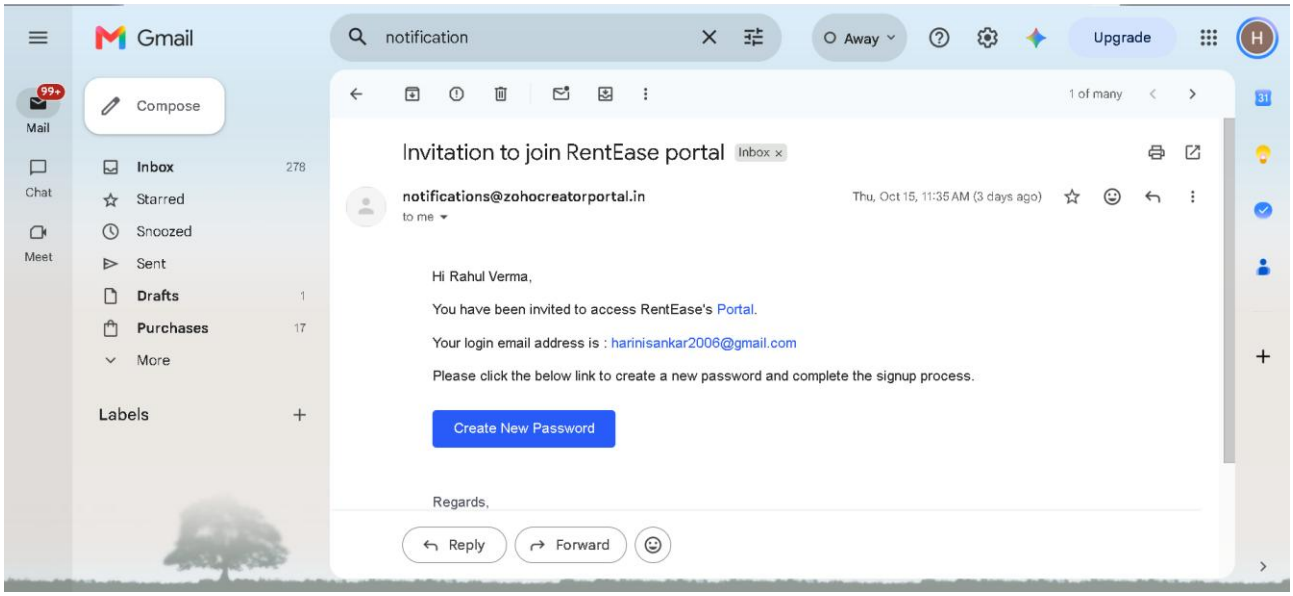


Figure 4: Invitation email

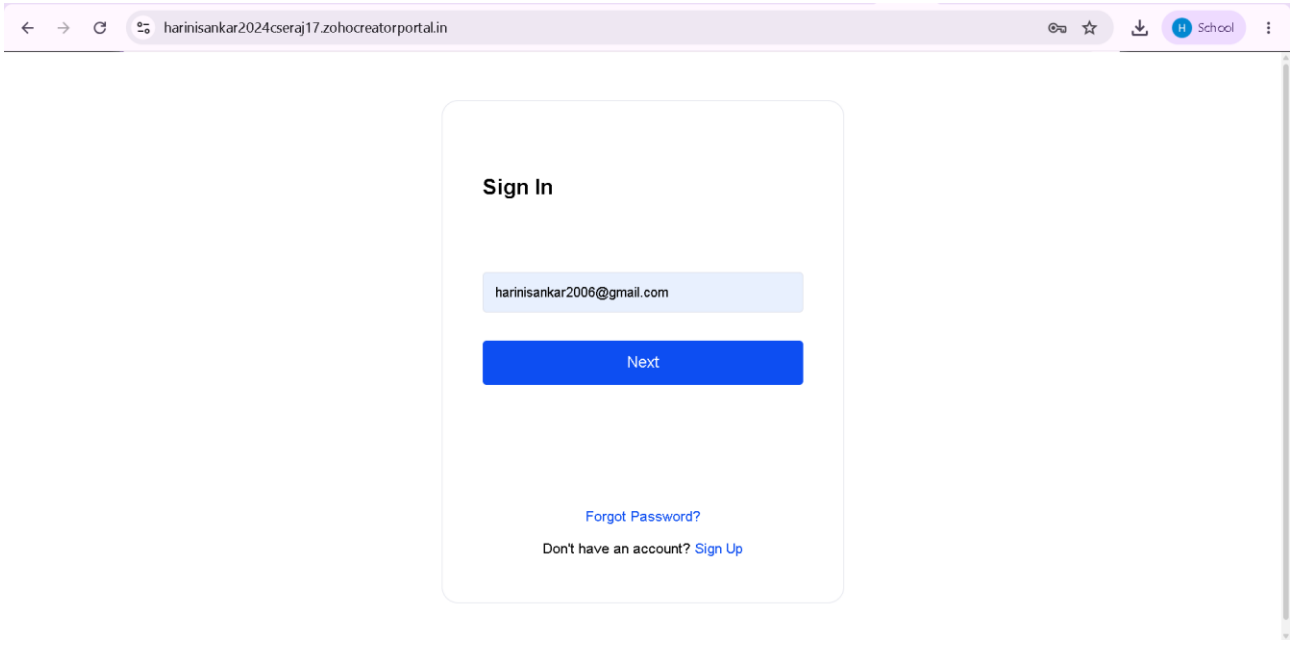


Figure 5: Tenant signing in to the portal

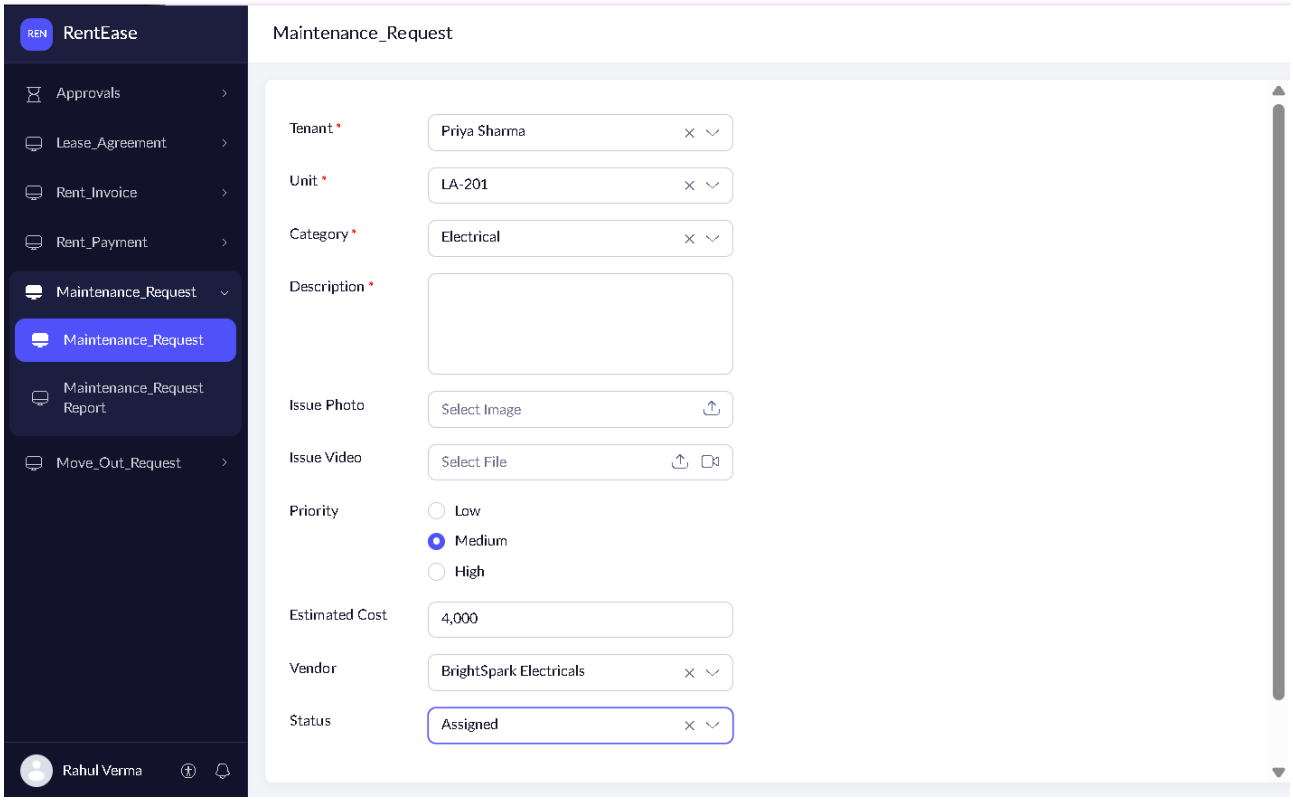


Figure 6: Tenant raising a maintenance request

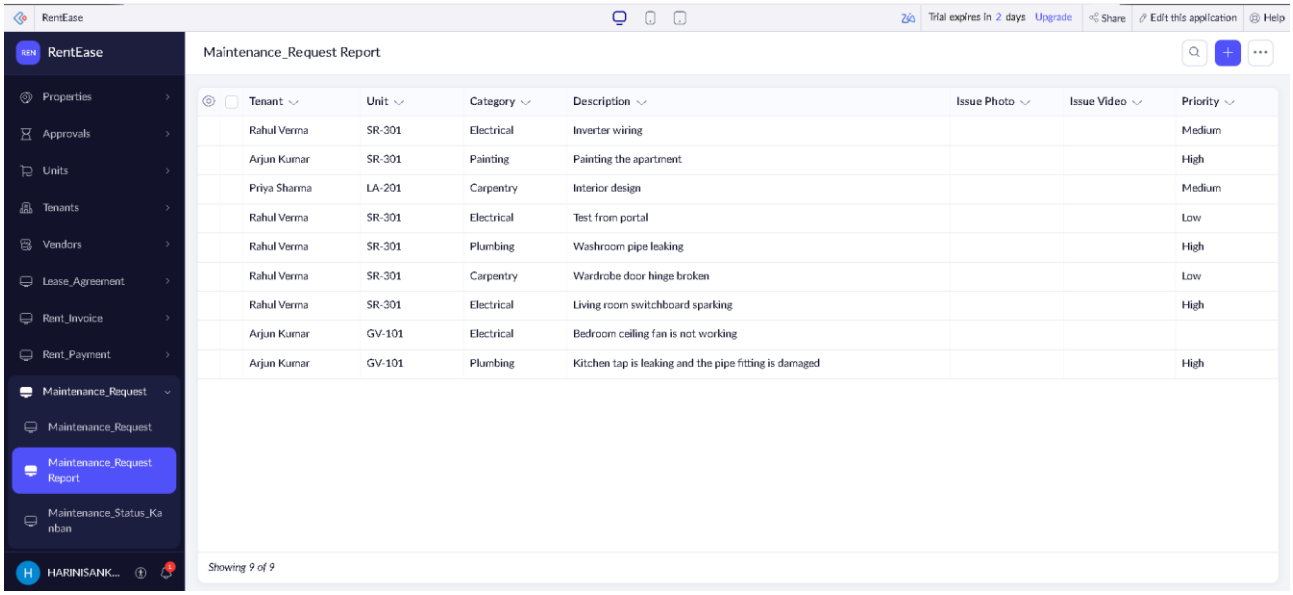


Figure 7: Tenant's request visible to the admin

7. Result

The RentEase portal was created for tenants, and the Tenant_Profile permission set was made its default. The tenant Rahul Verma was invited, signed in at the portal URL and raised a maintenance request, which then appeared in the application on the manager's side. The portal shows a tenant only the lease, invoice, payment, maintenance and move-out information that his permission set allows, without giving access to the rest of the application.